FIVE AGREEMENTS FOR COMMUNICATION

Classroom adaptations, not rules about what to believe

1. USE WORDS WITH CARE

Be honest. Avoid insults. Repair harm.



2. REMEMBER YOUR WORTH

Other people's words do not define you.



3. CHECK YOUR ASSUMPTIONS

Ask before deciding what someone meant.



4. PRACTISE, DON'T SEEK PERFECTION

Your best can change. Rest and support matter.



5. QUESTION AND LISTEN

Check your interpretation. Listen to understand.



Hurtful behaviour is not okay.
You can say stop and get help.

Inspired by The Four Agreements by don Miguel Ruiz and The Fifth Agreement by don Miguel Ruiz and don Jose Ruiz.

FEELINGS AND SHARED HUMAN NEEDS

Different feelings. Needs we all share.

FEELINGS ARE CLUES



calm | excited | worried | frustrated | lonely | curious

NEEDS ARE WHAT MATTER TO US



Safety and respect | Connection and belonging | Rest and care | Choice and space | Learning and meaning | Play and joy

SAME NEED, DIFFERENT WAYS

We can both need belonging and choose different activities.



A NEED IS NOT A DEMAND

"I need connection" is different from "You must play my game."



All feelings are welcome.
Not every action is okay.

Classroom adaptation inspired by Marshall Rosenberg's NVC and CNVC feelings and needs resources.

SAY WHAT MATTERS

Notice • Feel • Need • Request

1 NOTICE

Describe what happened, not a guessed intention.

"When you use that nickname...'



2 FEEL

Name a feeling, not a label for the other person.

"...I feel embarrassed."



3 NEED

Say what matters to you.

"Respect matters to me."



4 REQUEST

Ask for a clear, doable action.

"Please use my name."



THEN LISTEN

"What did you hear me asking?"

"Did I understand you?"





Words, writing, pictures and AAC all count.

You can simply say "Stop," leave, or seek adult help. No perfect sentence is required.

Classroom adaptation of Marshall Rosenberg's Nonviolent Communication.

ONE NEED, MANY POSSIBLE WAYS

We can care about both people's needs.

THE SITUATION

Two friends want to spend time together, but prefer different games.



SHARED NEED
CONNECTION

POSSIBLE STRATEGIES

Take turns choosing.



Find a third activity.



Plan time together later.



LISTEN AND CHECK



"Are you wanting some choice?"

"Would taking turns work?"

A guess is not a fact. Let the person tell you.

REQUESTS ARE NOT DEMANDS

Someone can say no to a proposed activity.



BOUNDARIES STILL MATTER

"Stop" means stop. No one owes unwanted touch or participation.
If you feel unsafe, move away and get adult help.



Classroom example inspired by NVC needs and strategies.

HEALTHY BOUNDARIES

My limits matter. Yours do too.

1 PERSONAL LIMITS

Boundaries protect our bodies, personal space, privacy, time and feelings.

Different people can have different limits. Those limits can change.

2 ASK. LISTEN. RESPECT.

Ask before touching, borrowing, taking a photo or sharing it.

A yes must be freely given. Someone can change their mind.

“No thanks.” → “Okay.” Stop when someone says stop.

3 A BOUNDARY IS NOT CONTROL

Boundary: “I will step away if the teasing continues.”

Control: “You are not allowed to have other friends.”

You can explain your limit without deciding someone else’s friendships.

4 WORDS YOU CAN USE

“Stop. Please give me space.”

“Do not share my photo.” “I need help.”

You may speak, point, use AAC or ask someone to help you communicate.

IF YOU FEEL UNSAFE

Move to safety and tell a trusted adult. Keep asking for help.

You do not need perfect words. It is not your fault if someone ignores your boundary.

Original classroom teaching aid • BC Grade 6 Health • Sources in teacher notes

Teaching notes: communication and boundaries

Five visual teaching aids for Grade 6 Health: four original illustrated posters plus one clear boundaries infographic. Use when the topic fits your learning sequence. This is not an official curriculum document, a scheduled lesson or an assigned assessment.

Shared needs, different experiences

In the NVC framework, needs are shared, but their importance in a moment and the ways people meet them differ. The six pairs shown are a starting selection, not a complete inventory. Feelings do not have one fixed meaning. Ask rather than infer a person’s feelings from a face, culture, disability or behaviour.

Teach boundaries explicitly

Distinguish a personal limit from a demand to control someone else. Everyday activity requests may be negotiated; unwanted contact, harassment and sharing a person’s photo without permission are not matters a child must negotiate away. Respect a refusal and check again when circumstances change. A person’s silence or uncertainty is not a freely given yes.

Use a fictional example: a student keeps using a nickname after being asked to stop. Identify the boundary, model a short response, and discuss what a bystander and trusted adult could do. Contrast this with two friends choosing different games: both may want belonging while choosing different activities.

Safety comes before the communication script

A child may leave, seek safety or get adult help without saying an NVC sentence, explaining feelings, being polite, or confronting the person. Harm is not the child’s fault. If one adult does not help, approach another trusted adult. Adults retain responsibility for safeguarding and appropriate health and safety care; explain necessary actions and offer choices where possible. Never turn this lesson into a promise that children must manage unsafe situations alone.

Optional evidence after teaching

For a fictional situation, students can identify the boundary, suggest a respectful response and explain when help is needed. They may speak, write, draw, point, use AAC or pass during practice. Do not require personal disclosures, public accounts of conflict, forgiveness, or reenactment of real incidents. This is a teaching option, not a new assignment or deadline.

Use with care • sources and attribution

Do not use the agreements to minimize harm. Question interpretations, not disclosures of harm. Do not require acceptance of spiritual claims. A request allows a response, while safety and personal boundaries still require respect. Assess communication learning rather than emotional vocabulary sophistication or a student’s willingness to disclose private information.

The Four Agreements — don Miguel Ruiz

https://www.miguelruiz.com/the-four-agreements/

The Fifth Agreement — don Miguel Ruiz and don Jose Ruiz

https://www.miguelruiz.com/the-fifth-agreement/

CNVC feelings and needs inventory — The Center for Nonviolent Communication © 2023

https://www.cnvc.org/images/pdf/Feelings-Needs-CNVC.pdf

NVC purpose and process — approach developed by Marshall Rosenberg

https://www.cnvc.org/about/purpose-of-nvc

BC Grade 6 Physical and Health Education

https://curriculum.gov.bc.ca/curriculum/physical-health-education/6/core

The classroom wording is paraphrased and the visuals are not official author or CNVC posters. The official CNVC inventory permits copying/sharing with credit. Author artwork is linked rather than copied. BC curriculum links support teaching healthy relationships, consent, personal boundaries and help-seeking; they do not make this a complete PHE assessment.

The first four posters use original AI-assisted illustrations. The boundaries page uses original typeset/vector design after illustration generation was unavailable. No photographs or private student information are included. Sources checked October 27, 2026.